
Pre-Read for Strategic Leadership Offsite

Subject: Current State of the Illinois-to-Wisconsin Data Migration & "Digital First" Strategy **Date:** February 16, 2026 **Facility Focus:** Franklin, WI Unified Campus

Strategic Context

As Yaskawa America transitions from fragmented operations in Illinois to the unified 800,000-square-foot Franklin campus, we are moving beyond a physical relocation to a "Digital First" operational model. This transformation is anchored by four strategic pillars: **Operational Efficiency, Planning & Budgeting, Customer Experience, and Business Agility.**

Current State of Data Migration

The migration of legacy data from Illinois (Waukegan) is currently underway. Our primary focus is the harmonization of data between the **Drives & Motion** and **Robotics** divisions.

- **Ontology Framework:** A foundational ontology (Drafted Jan 2026) exists to map these four pillars. This framework serves as the "brain" that enables our systems to comprehend the relationship between technology, processes, and data lineage.
- **Identification of Silos:** Current migration efforts have identified disparate schemas between SAP (ERP) and shop-floor MES systems. Bridging these is critical for the "Intelligent Factory" vision.
- **Knowledge Risk:** A significant portion of institutional knowledge remains "analog" or "tribal." The migration must include a strategy for digitizing this expertise before the final Illinois decommissioning.

The Objective

The goal of the upcoming 3-day offsite is to finalize the **Digital Thread**—a continuous flow of data from R&D to the customer—and to architect the **Semantic Layer** that will power our future AI Agents and Digital Twins.

Building the i3 Digital Thread (3 Days)

Theme: "Franklin Unified: From Integration to Intelligence"

Day 1: The Foundation (Governance & Semantics)

Goal: Align on the "Single Version of Truth" required for the Wisconsin facility.

- **09:00 AM – Vision Keynote:** The Franklin Campus as a consolidated global hub.
- **10:30 AM – Workshop: The Semantic Layer:** Mapping Illinois legacy data to the new Franklin schema; defining the Unified Product Entity.
- **01:00 PM – Data Governance Masterclass:** Establishing "Data Contracts" and assigning Domain Stewards for the 4 Pillars.
- **03:30 PM – Messaging & Workflow:** Designing the "Digital Handshake"—automated alerts from MES to ERP.
- **Evening:** Networking Dinner - Building Rapport Across Unified Divisions.

Day 2: The Factory (Digital Thread & Digital Twin)

Goal: Define the architecture of the Franklin "Intelligent Factory."

- **09:00 AM – Mapping the Digital Thread:** Traceability from R&D (IL) to Production (WI) to Global Customer Sites.
- **11:00 AM – The Digital Twin Deep-Dive:** Asset Twins for robotics lines and Factory Twins for consolidation simulations.
- **02:00 PM – Supply Chain & Logistics:** AI-driven local-sourcing optimization (targeting 90% local AC drive capacity).
- **04:00 PM – Analytics & RT Measurement:** Prototyping the "Franklin Command Center" dashboard for real-time OEE.

Day 3: The Intelligence (AI Agents & Agility)

Goal: Deploying AI Agents for reasoning and institutional knowledge security.

- **09:00 AM – AI Agent Use-Case Lab:** Designing the "Knowledge Retention Agent" for retiring/non-relocating staff.
- **11:00 AM – Scalable MLOps:** Cloud vs. Edge balance for Franklin-based machine learning.
- **01:00 PM – The "Franklin Manifesto":** Finalizing the 12-month roadmap and priority rankings.
- **03:00 PM – Closing & Accountability:** Assigning Executive Owners to the 4 Pillars.

Preparation Checklist for Attendees

1. **Review the Pillar Ontology:** Be prepared to discuss the relationships between your department and the shared data lineage.
2. **Silo Identification:** Come prepared with three specific examples where data fragmentation currently causes operational friction.
3. **Digital Twin Use Cases:** Identify one specific production process in your domain that would benefit most from a real-time digital simulation.